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Solution Engineer

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Introduction

I took up data management and computer interfaces in the United States Air Force. That was early 1985, and I have had my mind and hands on technology ever since. While I have specialized in Microsoft SQL Server engineering and development, my passion throughout has been service excellence.

In 35 years, I have left things better than I found them and have a knack for finding the pain points and areas of unmet need in a technical organization. I am able to marshal resources and ideas into sustainable and efficient solutions. Job changes resulted, but I kept myself attached to designing solutions for hard problems.

My passion is engineering solutions that liberate the good creative work of others.

Today, I live and go to school in Fort Atkinson, Wisconsin. I enjoy photography and building balanced stone art pieces.



Background

Carzwell XYZ, Negaunee, Michigan — May 2018 – Oct 2022

Business Owner & Chief Engineer

I provided freelance SQL Database and IT Administration services.

Catholic Community Services of Western Washington, Seattle, Washington — Jun 2017 – Oct 2017

Director of Client Information Services

The Director of Client Information Services is responsible for a small department which develops, manages and analyzes the CCS-CHS Client Information System database, which holds client demographic, service and case management information. This position is responsible for project management, personnel supervision, and service program support. In this project role, I identified a number of data and process deficiencies, as well as an unacceptable level of vendor service. All were resolved in my short non-profit tenure. I returned to sabbatical.

Allrecipes.com, Seattle, Washington — Jun 2015 – Oct 2016

Senior SQL Database Administrator

I cared for all the SQL Servers and databases behind the Allrecipes.com website. This included design and code review support, release and change management consultation, performance analysis, and incident response. Two key projects were automation of the Business Intelligence data warehouse data refresh process, and the ancillary efforts to refine and enhance the production site monitoring, alerting, and incident/outage management. The latter enabled a significantly faster response and escalation during incidents and outages. I created a process to capture 10x the data during outages - key for root cause analysis. I left Allrecipes for a much-needed sabbatical.

Wizards of the Coast, Renton, Washington — Apr 2014 - Jun 2015

Technical Analyst & SQL Database Administrator

This was a project effort focused on requirements gathering and analysis for increasing the reliability and efficiency of the pre-production environments. Additionally, I provided care and feeding for the data systems behind the very popular Magic The Gathering Online. Added significant value through creation of automated performance counter and KPI collection. Strong reputation for high quality project and service team support.

Microsoft, Redmond, Washington — Dec 2011 – Mar 2014

SQL Database Administrator

Serving in a production Tier 3 support and engineering role for 150+ SQL Servers spanning four geographical regions. The environment includes several multi-node clusters and databases upwards of 7 terabytes in size. Primary responsibilities consist of addressing escalated system issues and failures, capacity planning, development of monitoring processes, and release/deployment change review and approval. Current focus comprises automation of performance and capacity monitoring and reporting. Also provide guidance and mentoring to Tier 1 and Tier 2 staff. Designed and deployed a nine server (*three three-node clusters*) SQL 2012 AlwaysOn environment supporting the XBOX game Forza 5.



Corbis – Seattle, Washington Aug 2011 – Oct 2011

SQL Database Administrator

Assigned to short-term contract to restore an enterprise SQL Servers' performance and capacity metrics collection process and reporting database. The project involved T-SQL, batch, and Powershell scripting; SSIS; Dynamic Management Objects; and SSRS reports; and was completed in minimal time despite the absence of documentation and several missing components. Assisted with routine maintenance and performance issue troubleshooting (*deadlocks, slow processes, etc.*) for over 50 SQL Servers (*including three two-node active/passive clusters*) storing databases in the hundreds of gigabytes and several terabytes total. Monitored and maintained a complex transactional replication scheme.

National Research Corporation – Seattle, Washington (*HQ in Lincoln, NE*) Aug 2010 – May 2011

Technical Support Operations Manager, Corporate Infrastructure Group

As a senior contributor to the newly formed Corporate Infrastructure Group, invited to own and manage daily operations and infrastructure stabilization planning. This included enterprise support management, outage coordination, asset purchasing and management, and vendor relations. Hired, trained, and supervised a cohesive five-member service desk staff supporting business units in three states.

Outcome Concept Systems (*acquired by National Research Corporation in Aug 2010 (see above))*
Seattle, Washington Jul 2009 – Aug 2010

SQL Database Administrator

Hired to provide leadership and support of all business critical production, development, and QA data environments. Responsible for issue response, scheduled maintenance, performance tuning, disaster recovery, and data security. Designed and implemented monitoring and alerting, security standards, and automated environment refresh processes. Developed and employed automated database build, verification, and deployment system for use by the development and QA teams. Technologies and tools used included SQL native and Redgate SQL Backup tools, SQL Profiler and DB Tuning Advisor, Business Intelligence Development Studio, and IPMonitor.

WA State Board for Community and Technical Colleges – Bellevue, Washington Dec 2008 – Jul 2009

SQL Database Administrator/Database Developer

Member of SBCTC IT providing daily system monitoring, data change request support, and fault troubleshooting in production, QA, and development environments. Supported transition from legacy data management system to MS SQL Server. Scrutinized vendor-supplied database code – providing feedback for improved performance.

Zillow – Seattle, Washington Jan 2006 – Oct 2008

Database Administrator/Database Developer

Member of Data Integration-Warehousing Team (DIT) developing VLDB data import and workflow solutions supporting the Zillow.com site. Project efforts included design and construction of new data source solutions, high volume data transformation, and ongoing data accuracy refinements. Routine work included database schema and interface (*stored procedure*) design and development, source code management, and database build & deployment support. Transitioned to database development role after completing a 90-day contract as a SQL database administrator. Served in critical operational role through the product's initial launch. Developed important time-saving automation for large database deployments across development, QA, and production environments.

Expedia – Bellevue, Washington Sep 2000 – Dec 2005

Build & Deployment Services Manager

Invited to provide technical leadership for Expedia Worldwide product development source code management, builds, and deployment. Assembled new B&D group: recruited, trained, supervised 7 team members. Recommended and implemented quality improvement solutions to overhaul test environments, build and deployment schedules, and communication protocols. Communicated extensively with various development, testing, and operational teams to manage requirements through several major releases and countless emergency hotfixes. Established and refined service levels and workflow management. Spearheaded transition to Rapid Release model, efficiently embracing a six-fold workload increase for the Build and Deployment team.



Proactive member of 2-man team providing 24x7 database management and support for Expedia's early production SQL servers. Automated numerous administrative tasks from replication monitoring to database backup and migration. Produced detailed application and database change documentation. Streamlined routine site configuration updates through creation of scripts and templates – saving several man-hours weekly. Improved SQL support and issue resolution by stabilizing lab database environments; instituted innovative configuration standards and service processes.

WEB3000, INC. – Redmond, Washington Nov 1999 – Sep 2000

SQL Database Administrator/Director, Technical Operations

Staffed and led 13-member 24x7 IT support and response team, while overseeing all operational aspects of a Technical Operations department within a rapidly growing startup. Assisted in the development of critical configuration and change management policies and procedures. Served as Production Database Administrator.

HEWLETT PACKARD – Boise, Idaho Apr 1999 – Nov 1999

SQL Server Database Administrator

Recruited to join development team tasked with designing new SQL server-based business application at the Hewlett Packard Boise site. Managed configuration and processes by implementing stored procedures, triggers, and scheduled tasks. Provided 24x7 technical support of servers. Developed change monitoring system, automated object scripting and backup for version management. Enhanced operations by implementing stabilized backup procedures, monitoring, and alerting functions. Instrumental in expanding IT SQL service offerings by documenting and automating database administration tasks.

FIRST SECURITY INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY – Boise, Idaho Mar 1997 – Apr 1999

Technical Specialist/Database Administrator

Accountable for development, delivery, and maintenance of retail lending business applications. Performed all activities related to database/server administration for more than 20 Microsoft NT servers and 5 Microsoft SQL servers. Provided technical support to 300+ end users as primary contact for daily operations and problem resolution. Identified, planned, and documented capacity and functional specifications. Served as Team Leader; guided and mentored a team of six developers and technicians.

BOISE STATE UNIVERSITY – Boise, Idaho May 1996 – Mar 1997

Network Administrator

Managed Novell Network LAN/WAN comprised of 400+ nodes and 5 fileservers within a diverse academic environment. Provided technical support for hardware, operating systems, and applications. Developed an automated system for maintenance and reload of several dynamic student computer labs with 10-20 workstations each in order to dramatically improve availability and optimize operations.



Military Experience

United States Air Force Jan 1985 - Apr 1996

Non-Commissioned Officer-in-Charge, Information Systems & Personnel Services

Served as Assistant Network Manager for Host Navy command's 215-user local area network; accountable for network information, user access security, and system maintenance. Provided technical support and maintenance for all Air Force detachment IT resources. Devised and managed a comprehensive database system with more than 23,000 enlisted and 8,000 officer records. Instituted an automated process that facilitated completion of separation documents with a high degree of accuracy. Awarded the Air Force Commendation Medal with one device, and the Air Force Achievement Medal.

